Product Brief: The Citadel

Oct 21, 2026 · @Htar

The Citadel: Skills that get you in

Product type: Web app

Target audience

	Learners	Organisations
Who	Young people starting or changing their career	Partner companies that hire young talent
Age / type	18–30	IT companies, software houses and outsourcing firms, tech startups, digital agencies
Industry	IT field	IT field
Location	Myanmar	Myanmar
What they want	A clear path to a first IT job	Skilled, tested young talent, fast and at low cost

The organisation types are a first guess; confirm with the companies we can actually reach as partners.

Problem statement

Young people aged 18–30 in Myanmar and across Asia struggle to find a clear career path and land their first real job. At the same time, organisations struggle to find skilled young talent.

For young people

- **No clear roadmap:** they don't know which skills to learn or in what order to reach the job they want.
- **Learning doesn't lead anywhere:** online courses end with a certificate, not a job, and many learners give up before finishing.
- **No proof of skill:** entry-level jobs ask for experience they don't have yet.

- **Help is scattered:** courses, mentors and job listings sit on different platforms that don't connect.

For organisations

- **Hiring is slow and costly:** finding skilled young people takes time, job ads and many interviews.
- **Skills are hard to check:** a CV or certificate doesn't show whether a candidate can actually do the work.
- **Hiring risk:** taking on interns with no proven skills can waste training time and money.

User reality

How our two users try to solve the problem today, what breaks, and what they really want. This comes from team knowledge and desk research; confirm it in user interviews.

	Learners (18–30)	Organisations (IT companies)
Current behaviour	Watch free YouTube tutorials; buy random online courses; ask friends or Facebook groups what to learn; apply for jobs on Facebook and LinkedIn	Post jobs on Facebook and job boards; rely on referrals; screen many CVs; train new hires from scratch
Frustrations	Don't know what to learn first; give up when progress feels invisible; certificates don't lead to jobs; entry roles ask for experience; can't tell real job offers from fake ones	Many applicants, few with real skills; CVs and certificates don't show what people can do; hiring is slow and costly
Motivations	Land a first real IT job or internship; earn a stable income; grow a career they're proud of	Hire skilled, reliable young people quickly and at low cost; build a pipeline of future talent

Stakeholder mapping

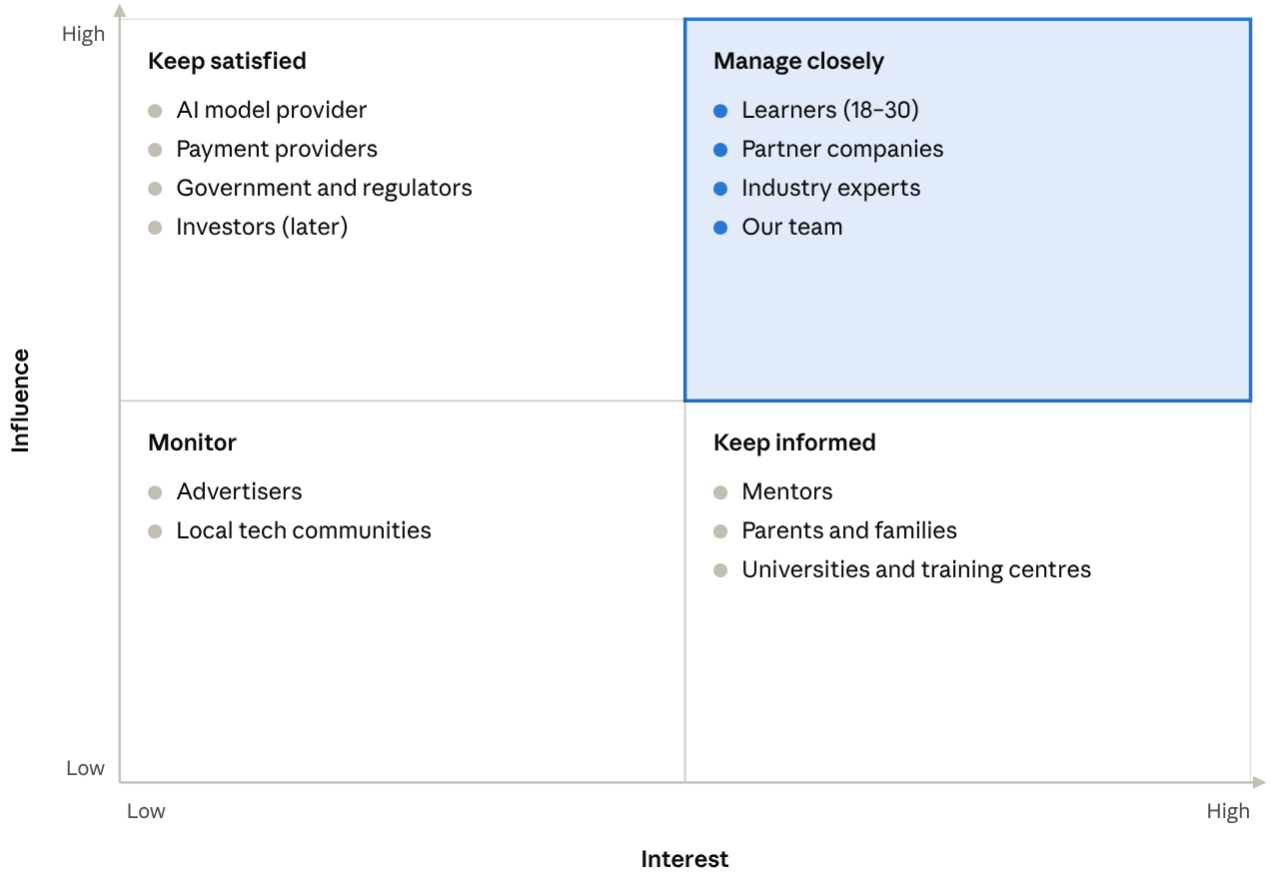
Brainstorm: all stakeholders

First list from the team's 5-minute brainstorm; add anyone the group thinks of.

Group	Stakeholders
Users	Learners aged 18–30 · partner companies
Course and learning	Industry experts · mentors · universities and training centres
Team	Our team
Suppliers	AI model provider · payment providers · advertisers
Wider community	Parents and families · local tech communities · government and regulators · investors (later)

Prioritise: influence–interest matrix

Learners, partner companies and experts need the closest attention



influence–interest matrix · placement by zone, team's first view

Items sit in a zone, not an exact spot. Move any stakeholder the team sees differently.

Competitor analysis

Direct competitors link learning to work, but none does it for young people in Myanmar. Indirect competitors cover only one piece: jobs, tests, mentors or free lessons.

Direct competitors

Competitor	What it is	Pros	Cons	Gap
Forage (global)	Free job simulations made by companies	Closest model: free for students, companies pay; 100+ employers	Big Western employers, English; no clear link to interviews	Not in Myanmar; no local companies
Coursera (global)	Online courses and professional certificates	Big-name certificates (Google, IBM, Meta); about $49/month	Self-paced, many don't finish; English; hiring network is US employers	A certificate, not a job; no Myanmar employers
Futura School (Myanmar)	Online school for design, product management, digital marketing	Local; self-paced; priced in MMK (30,000–600,000 per course); experienced instructors	Only one IT course (front-end); manual payment by Messenger and screenshot	No internship or job placement on its site

Indirect competitors

Competitor	What it is	Pros	Cons	Gap
LinkedIn (global)	Jobs network and LinkedIn Learning	Largest professional network and job listings	Entry-level roles ask for experience young people lack	No guided path from learning to a first job

Competitor	What it is	Pros	Cons	Gap
Internshala (India)	Job board for internships, fresher jobs and short trainings	Strong for hiring in India; many applicants	Applications arrive unscreened, so the company screens everyone	No proof of skill; not in Myanmar
HackerRank (global)	Coding tests that companies use to screen developers	Standard way to test coders	Used by companies, not learners; tests coding only	No learning; nothing for design, QA or marketing
ADPList (global)	1:1 mentorship marketplace	Free sessions; paid sessions where ADPList keeps a 10% fee	Mentorship only; no structured learning path	No courses, no jobs or internships
Free tutorials and Facebook job groups (Myanmar)	YouTube lessons and job posts in Facebook groups	Free, and already used by young people	No structure; fake offers hard to spot	No proof of skill; no verified companies

LinkedIn, HackerRank, and free tutorials and Facebook groups are general knowledge, not checked for this doc. Internshala comes from one review written by a competitor. Other sources checked 19–21 Oct 2026.

Our opportunity

- **Join the pieces:** one place for a career roadmap, IT courses and real opportunities.
- **Company challenge, then interview:** learners prove skills on a real company task, which no local platform offers.
- **Local and trusted:** verified Myanmar companies, with no fees to apply.
- **AI makes it affordable:** AI checks challenge answers at scale, which used to be too costly.

Coursera gives you a certificate. We give you an interview.

Possible solution

An AI-supported learning platform that takes young people from learning a skill to a real internship, and gives organisations a ready pool of tested talent.

For young people

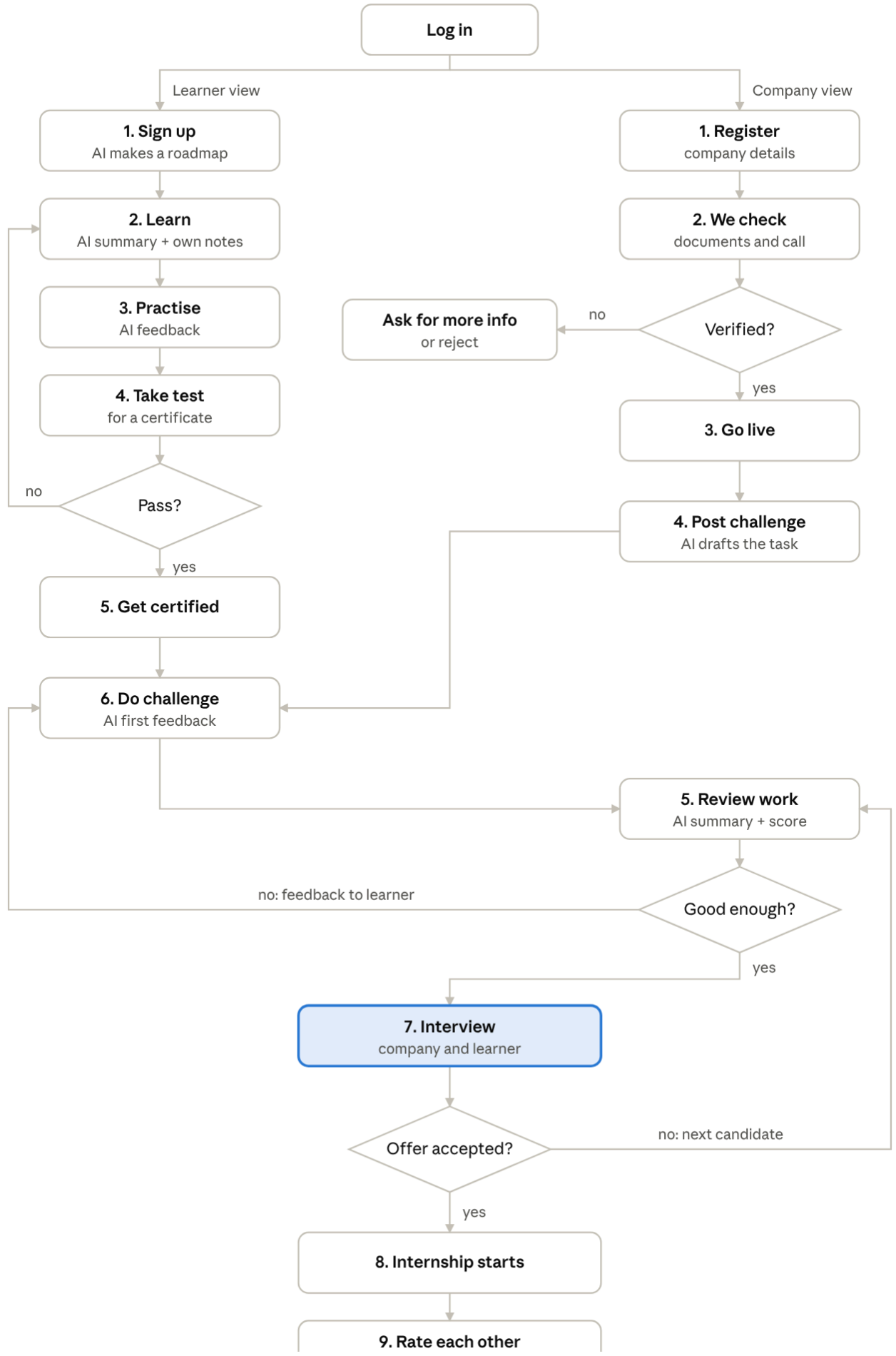
- **Clear career path:** learners pick a career goal and get a step-by-step roadmap of IT courses.
- **AI study tools:** AI takes notes and summarises each lesson so learners keep up and remember more.
- **Real company challenges:** every course ends with a practical challenge set by a partner company.
- **Internship unlocked:** learners who pass the challenge get that company's internship interview.

For organisations

- **Skilled talent, fast:** partners meet young people who have already proven their skills.
- **Low-cost hiring:** less spending on job ads, screening and interviews, because the platform does the first filter.
- **Skills they trust:** companies set the challenge themselves, so they know exactly what each candidate can do.
- **Talent made to fit:** courses train learners in the skills partners actually need.

User flow

Learners and companies use one app and meet at the interview

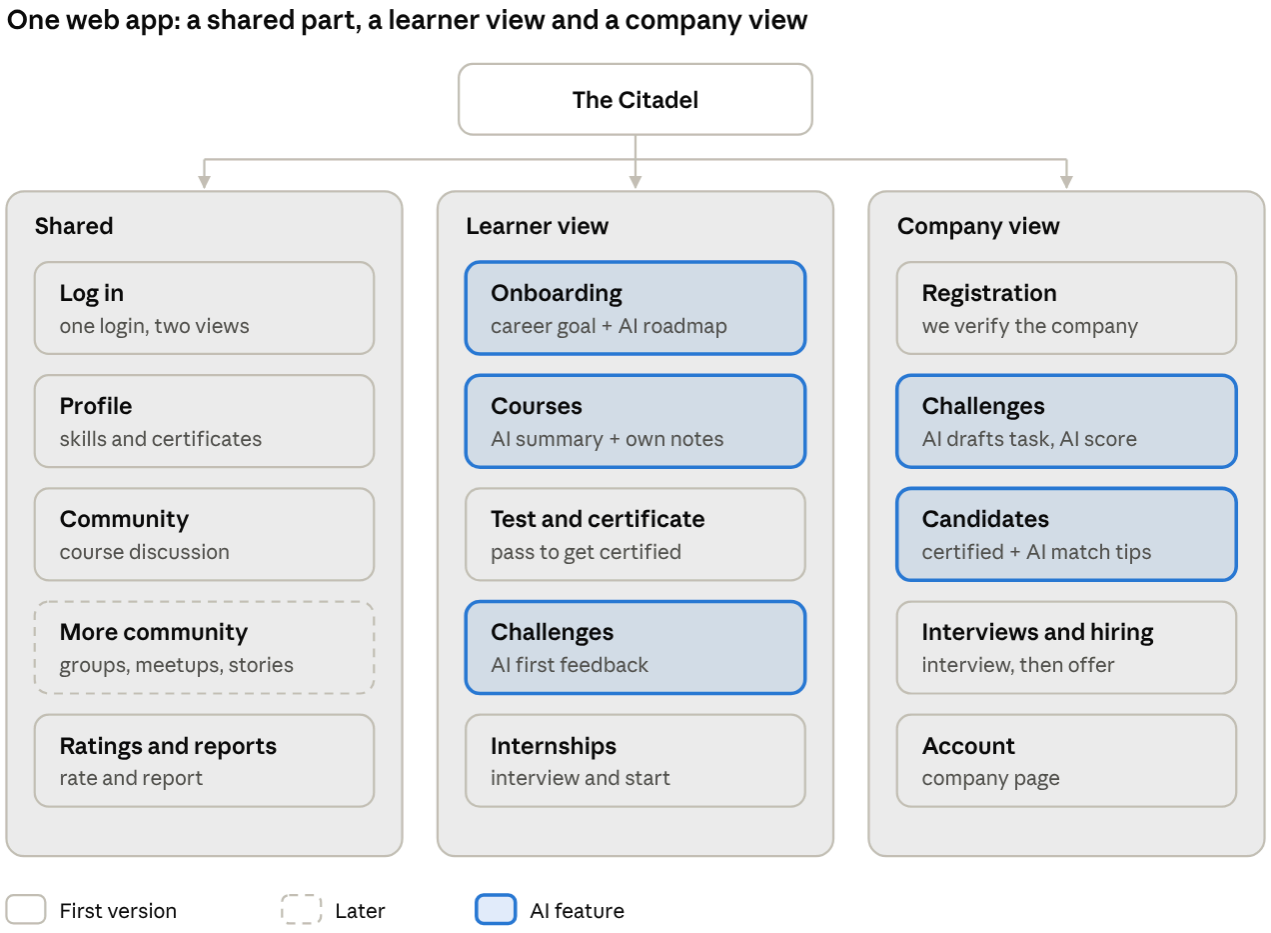


learner and company

user flow · one web app, learner and company views

Learners and companies log in to the same web app and each sees their own view. A learner learns, takes a test, gets certified, then does a company challenge. A company registers, is verified by our team, then posts challenges and reviews the work. Both meet at the interview, and a failed test or a weak answer loops back with feedback.

Information architecture



information architecture · shared, learner and company sections, AI tinted

The web app has a shared part (login, profile, community, ratings), a learner view of five sections and a company view of five. AI sections are tinted blue; AI match tips for companies come after the demo, and so do more community features.

AI features

AI feature	Where	What goes in	What comes out	In demo?
Career roadmap	Learner › Onboarding	Career goal, current skills, hours per week	An ordered list of courses to take	Yes
Lesson summary	Learner › Courses	The lesson's text or transcript	Key points and a short summary, next to the learner's own notes	Yes
Challenge feedback	Learner › Challenges	The learner's answer and the company's rubric	A first round of feedback before the company reviews	Yes
Task drafting	Company › Challenges	What skill the company needs	A draft challenge task and rubric	Yes
Work summary and score	Company › Challenges	The learner's submitted work	A short summary and a score to help the review	Yes
Match tips	Company › Candidates	Certified learners and a company's open challenge	Tips on which candidates fit	Later

AI pre-screens and supports; the partner company makes every hiring decision.

Community

Learners and companies share one community inside the web app. It is free, and moderated by our team.

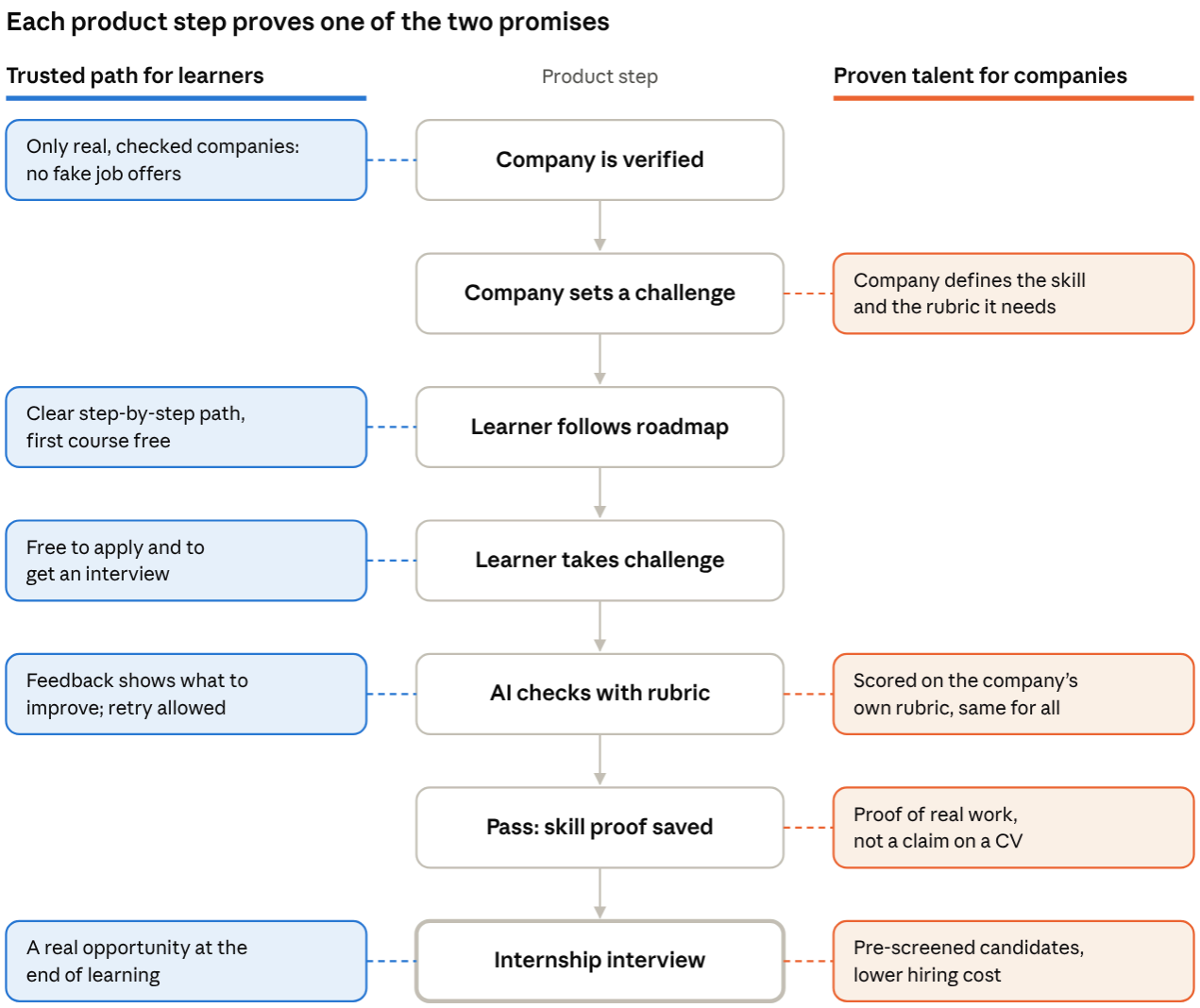
- **First version:** course discussion, and challenge questions that a verified company answers.
- **Rules:** only verified companies post as a company, every post has a Report button, no sharing challenge answers, no private contact details.
- **Later:** study groups, online meetups and success stories.

Unique value

Coursera gives you a certificate. We give you an interview, and companies get talent they've already tested.

How the product proves our value

A trusted path for learners, proven talent for companies.



how each product step proves our two values

The middle column is the product flow. Left notes show what makes it trusted for learners; right notes show what makes the talent proven for companies.

How we verify organisations

Every company is checked before it can post a challenge or an internship. This is what makes the learner path trusted.

Stage	What we check or require
Before joining	Business registration documents

Stage	What we check or require
Before joining	A working office address, phone number and email on the company's own domain
Before joining	Website and history on LinkedIn or Facebook
Before joining	A short call between our team and a company representative
Before joining	Internship terms written up front: role, duration, location and any stipend
Always	Never ask learners for money
Always	Never ask learners to hand over a passport or ID card
Always	Only post internships that match the approved terms
Over time	Learners rate the company after an internship
Over time	A "Report" button on every listing
Over time	Each company is re-checked once a year; rule breakers are removed

In the demo: each company shows a "Verified" badge. Tapping it lists what was checked (registration, contact, no fees).

Next steps

- Expand to other Asian countries after the Myanmar launch.

Mentorship (later)

Not in the first version; we add it once courses and partner challenges work.

- Mentors guide learners on their career path.
- 1:1 mentor sessions booked on the platform, priced like ADPList: free or paid sessions, a flat 10% platform fee taken from the mentor, paid out after the session.
- AI mentor matching from the learner's goal and progress.
- Mentors come from industry instructors and, later, learners who landed jobs.